

1.2 Upgrading To Vista

While purchasing a standalone unit is an option, you might also consider upgrading to a version of Vista from your current Windows OS (most likely XP). Your choices depend on the version of Windows currently running on your PC and the type of computer hardware you have to run certain features. Here's how you can start planning for an upgrade to Windows Vista.

1.2.1 The options

You can upgrade from your current edition of Windows XP or Windows 2000 to a corresponding or better edition of Windows Vista by purchasing and installing an upgrade copy of Vista. If you're upgrading multiple PCs in a household, you can look at the Windows Vista Family Discount. Depending upon the version of Windows you're upgrading from, Vista will either force a clean install or will allow you to install over the older OS (In-place option).

Upgrade to Windows Vista				
Previous OS	Home Basic	Home Premium	Business	Ultimate
Windows XP Professional	Clean install	Clean install	In-place option available	In-place option available
Windows XP Home	In-place option available	In-place option available	In-place option available	In-place option available
Windows XP Media Center	Clean install	In-place option available	Clean install	In-place option available
Windows XP Tablet PC	Clean install	Clean install	In-place option available	In-place option available
Windows XP Professional X64	Clean install	Clean install	Clean install	Clean install
Windows 2000	Clean install	Clean install	Clean install	Clean install